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Aston University
BIRMINGHAM UK

NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarships (IFY, IY1 and PMP)

September 2026 Intake
Terms and Conditions

V1
25th February 2026

international@aston.ac.uk

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Purpose and Scope

This document outlines the eligibility, assessment criteria, and conditions for full-time, self-funded international applicants progressing from an NCUK pathway programme to be considered for the NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarship at Aston University for the September 2026 intake.

The NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarship is a competitive, application-based scholarship. Applicants must submit a formal scholarship application for consideration. Submission of an application does not guarantee the award of a scholarship.

All applications are assessed in line with the published eligibility criteria and these Terms & Conditions. Scholarship awards are subject to University approval and to overall availability.

These Terms and Conditions are correct at the time of publication and may be subject to change.

1. General Provisions

1.1 To be eligible for the NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarship, applicants must be classified as Overseas for tuition fee purposes.

1.2 Applicants must hold an offer for a full-time, taught undergraduate or postgraduate taught degree programme delivered on campus at Aston University, Birmingham, commencing in September 2026.

1.3 Applicants must be progressing directly from one of the following NCUK pathway programmes:

- International Foundation Year (IFY);
- International Year One (IY1); or
- Pre-Masters Programme (PMP).

1.4 Applicants must meet all academic and non-academic conditions stated in their offer letter.

1.5 Applicants must be self-funded. Students whose tuition fees are wholly or partially funded by a sponsor are not eligible, unless the sponsor has an official written agreement with Aston University confirming eligibility for scholarship consideration.

1.6 The NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarship is a competitive, application-based scholarship. Meeting the eligibility criteria and submitting a scholarship application does not create an entitlement to a scholarship.

1.7 By submitting a scholarship application, applicants confirm their understanding of the competitive nature of the award, the conditional assessment process, and the

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finality of scholarship decisions, subject only to appeal on the grounds set out in Section 6.

1.8 In order for the scholarship to be applied, successful applicants must:

- Submit a completed scholarship application by the published deadline;
- Pay the required programme deposit by the deadline stated in their offer letter; and
- Successfully enrol by the latest enrolment date for their September 2026 programme.

Applicants are not required to pay a programme deposit prior to submitting a scholarship application.

2. Scholarship Basis and Exclusions

2.1 Competitive, Application-Based Award

The NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarship is a competitive, application-based award for eligible NCUK progression applicants.

Submission of a scholarship application does not guarantee the award of a scholarship. All applications are assessed against the published eligibility criteria and these Terms & Conditions. Awards are subject to approval by the University and to overall scholarship availability.

2.2 Programme Exclusions

The following programmes are not eligible for the NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarship:

Undergraduate:

- MBChB Medicine
- MPharm Pharmacy
- MOptom Optometry
- BSc Nursing Studies
- BSc Healthcare Science (Audiology)

Postgraduate:

- PGDip / MSc Overseas Pharmacy Assessment Programme (OSPAP)
- MSc Physician Associate Practice
- All MBA programmes
- All MRes programmes
- All research-only programmes

Additional programme exclusions may apply where explicitly stated by the University.

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2.3 Progression Exclusions

Applicants are eligible only where they are progressing directly from one of the NCUK pathway programmes specified in Clause 1.3 to an eligible programme at Aston University for the September 2026 intake.

Applicants who are not progressing from an eligible NCUK pathway programme are not eligible for the NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarship.

3. Scholarship Availability, Assessment, and Allocation

3.1 The NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarship is limited in number. The University sets a capped allocation for the September 2026 intake.

3.2 Scholarship applications will only be subject to competitive assessment where the number of eligible scholarship applications exceeds the available scholarship allocation.

3.3 Where the number of eligible scholarship applications does not exceed the available scholarship allocation, all eligible applicants who have submitted a completed scholarship application will be awarded the scholarship, subject to meeting all eligibility, deposit payment, and enrolment requirements.

3.4 Where the number of eligible scholarship applications exceeds the available scholarship allocation, applications will be assessed competitively, based solely on the applicant's response to the assessed scholarship question contained within the application form.

3.5 In oversubscription scenarios, applications will be evaluated using a consistent internal scoring rubric, applying agreed internal weightings, and reviewed through Aston University's internal scholarship decision-making processes and panel review.

3.6 The University is not required to disclose individual scores, scoring thresholds, internal weightings, panel discussions, or deliberative materials.

3.7 The University reserves the right not to award all available scholarships.

4. Awarding the Scholarship

4.1 The scholarship is awarded as a tuition fee discount applied to the eligible programme of study. No cash alternative or cost-of-living payment is available.

4.2 A student may normally hold only one Aston University scholarship per programme of study. Where a student is eligible for more than one scholarship or tuition fee discount, the award of the highest value will usually apply.

4.2a Notwithstanding clause 4.2, the University reserves the right, at its sole discretion, to permit the NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarship to be held in combination

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with a separate, specifically designated scholarship or tuition fee award, where this is expressly approved and communicated by the University.

4.3 The scholarship is not transferable to another applicant, programme, intake, academic year, or institution.

4.4 Scholarships are valid only for the September 2026 intake and cannot be deferred or carried forward to a future academic year.

5. Receiving and Retaining the Scholarship

5.1 The scholarship will be applied to the student's tuition fee account only after:

- the programme deposit has been paid; and
- the student has successfully enrolled within the required enrolment period.

5.2 Unless otherwise stated, NCUK IFY and NCUK PMP awards apply to the first year of tuition fees only.

5.3 NCUK IY1 awards apply to Year 2 (first year at Aston University) and the final year of study only, excluding any placement year.

5.4 To retain the NCUK IY1 Scholarship for the final year of study, students must:

- Achieve an overall average of 60% or above at first attempt in their first academic year of study at Aston University;
- Pass all modules at first attempt;
- Remain classified as Overseas for tuition fee purposes; and
- Remain fully enrolled and in attendance, as defined by Aston University.

Marks achieved through reassessment, resits, or repeat attempts will not be used to satisfy the 60% requirement.

5.5 Students repeating modules, whether with or without attendance, are not eligible to receive the scholarship in respect of the repeated study.

5.6 Students who withdraw from Aston University part-way through an academic year will no longer be eligible for the scholarship. Any tuition fee discount already applied may be withdrawn, and the student will be liable for the full tuition fee for that academic year.

5.7 Where a student suspends their studies and takes a Leave of Absence:

- If the Leave of Absence covers a complete academic year, no tuition fee is charged, and no scholarship is payable.
- If the Leave of Absence is taken part-way through an academic year, scholarship eligibility will be assessed in line with Aston University's Tuition Fees Charging Policy and may be adjusted on a pro-rata basis.

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6. Appeals and Final Decision

6.1 Scholarship decisions are made by a University panel operating in accordance with internal procedures. The panel's decision is final.

6.2 Appeals may only be made on the grounds of procedural error, defined strictly as a demonstrable failure by the University to follow the published Terms & Conditions or stated assessment process.

6.3 Appeals will not be considered based on:

- academic judgement or comparative merit;
- the content, quality, or score of an application response;
- disagreement with the outcome of the assessment;
- the exercise of panel discretion;
- the availability, allocation, or exhaustion of scholarship places; or
- comparisons with other applicants or awards made.

6.4 The University is not required to disclose individual scores, ranking positions, scoring thresholds, assessor comments, internal weightings, or panel deliberations in response to an appeal.

6.5 Where no procedural error is identified, the original decision will stand and will not be reconsidered.

6.6 Appeals must be submitted in writing within the timeframe specified by the University. Late or incomplete appeals will not be accepted.

6.7 Evidence submitted after the final eligibility or assessment decision will not normally be considered unless the applicant can demonstrate that the information could not reasonably have been made available at the time of application.

6.8 The University will not enter into further correspondence regarding a scholarship decision once the appeals process has concluded.

7. Interpretation, Precedence and Governing Law

10.1 In the event of any inconsistency between these Terms and Conditions and any other University publication, webpage, correspondence or third-party communication, these Terms and Conditions shall take precedence.

10.2 Applicants should rely only on these published Terms and Conditions. No informal communication, marketing material, webinar statement, agent representation or partner institution communication shall be binding unless confirmed in writing by Aston University.

10.3 Any discretion exercised by the University does not create precedent or entitlement for other applicants or future intakes.

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10.4 These Terms and Conditions are governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of England and Wales.

Terms & Conditions Validity

2026/27 Academic Year (September 2026 intake only)

Further Information and Enquiries

All enquiries relating to the NCUK Articulation and Progression Scholarship must be directed to:

Aston University International Office

Email: international@aston.ac.uk

END